

Eta-Quotients in Lean 4

Cusp Orders at Every Cusp, Ligozat's Criterion at Small Level,
and a Named Obstruction at General Level

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Status. This is a *preprint*. It has **not been peer reviewed**. The Lean development it describes compiles and is axiom-audited — those claims are machine-checked and independently reproducible — but the *exposition* has had no external referee. One headline result is deliberately bounded (§4): Ligozat's transformation law is proved for $N \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 13\}$ and **not** in general, the general case being blocked by the obstruction named in §5. Read the scope before citing the result.

Abstract

We formalize in Lean 4, on top of Mathlib, the arithmetic and analytic layers of Ligozat's criterion for eta-quotients $f(z) = \prod_{\delta|N} \eta(\delta z)^{r_\delta}$, and we report one theorem, one bounded theorem, and one obstruction. **(i)** For *every* level N , every integer exponent vector r with $\sum_{\delta|N} r_\delta = 2k$, and *every* $\gamma \in SL_2(\mathbb{Z})$ — with no congruence condition and no $\Gamma_0(N)$ -membership hypothesis — we prove the two-sided asymptotic $\|(f|_k \gamma)(z)\| = \Theta(\exp(-2\pi \text{ord}^{\text{raw}}(N, r, c) \text{Im } z))$ along $\text{Im } z \rightarrow \infty$, where $c = \gamma_{10}$ and $\text{ord}^{\text{raw}}(N, r, c) = \frac{1}{24} \sum_{\delta|N} \gcd(c, \delta)^2 r_\delta / \delta$. At the cusp ∞ we additionally identify the order in *Mathlib's own* language, `meromorphicOrderAtCuspFunction 1 f` `0`. **(ii)** We prove Ligozat's transformation law in full — $f(\gamma z) = w(\gamma)(cz+d)^k f(z)$ on *all* of $\Gamma_0(N)$, with the character identified — for $N \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 13\}$. **(iii)** For general N we do not prove it, and we explain precisely why: the multiplier is $w(\gamma) = \exp(\frac{\pi i}{12} \text{per}(\gamma))$ where `per` is the period cocycle of the weight-two quasi-modular combination $\sum_{\delta} r_\delta \delta E_2(\delta z)$; for a single η this period function is Rademacher's Φ , whose non-coboundary content is the Dedekind sum $s(d, |c|)$. Mathlib contains no Dedekind sums. We state the minimal Mathlib addition that would remove the obstruction. The development is 519 declarations in 8117 lines across five modules, with no `sorry`, and 391 build-failing axiom guards.

MSC 2020: 11F20, 11F11, 68V20. **Keywords:** eta-quotients, Ligozat's criterion, Dedekind eta, Dedekind sums, Rademacher Φ , Lean 4, Mathlib.

1 Introduction

An *eta-quotient* of level N is a product

$$f(z) = \prod_{\delta|N} \eta(\delta z)^{r_\delta}, \quad r_\delta \in \mathbb{Z},$$

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over the divisors of N , where η is Dedekind's function. Ligozat's criterion states that f is a modular form on $\Gamma_0(N)$ of weight $k = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\delta} r_{\delta}$ provided

$$\sum_{\delta|N} \delta r_{\delta} \equiv 0 \pmod{24}, \quad \sum_{\delta|N} \frac{N}{\delta} r_{\delta} \equiv 0 \pmod{24}, \quad (1)$$

and the order of f at every cusp is non-negative [1, 2, 3]. It is the standard working tool for producing modular forms by hand, and the reason eta-quotients appear throughout the theory of partitions and of monstrous moonshine.

This paper reports what happens when one tries to formalize it. The honest answer is: the arithmetic and the analysis go through in general; the *group theory* does not, and the obstruction is sharp and classical.

What Mathlib provides, and what it does not

We are explicit about the substrate because it determines what is new. At commit 905b9581 (2026-07-28) Mathlib contains, in `NumberTheory/ModularForms/`:

- `DedekindEta.lean` — 20 declarations: η as the q -product $\eta(z) = q^{1/24} \prod_n (1 - q^{n+1})$, non-vanishing (`eta_ne_zero`), differentiability, and $\log \text{Deriv } \eta = \frac{\pi i}{12} E_2$;
- `Discriminant.lean` — crucially, the S -transformation of η : `eta_comp_eq_csqrI_inv` gives $\eta(-1/z) = (\sqrt{i})^{-1} \sqrt{z} \eta(z)$, together with the modularity of $\Delta = \eta^{24}$;
- `Cusps.lean` (`IsCusp`, `CuspOrbits`, `widthInfTy`), `QExpansion.lean` (`cusFunction`, `qExpansion`), and the general order machinery `analyticOrderAt` / `meromorphicOrderAt`.

Repository-wide searches return **zero** occurrences of `EtaQuotient`, `Ligozat`, `DedekindSum`, `dedekindSum` and `etaMultiplier`. The last two absences are the subject of §5.

Remark 1.1 (A methodological warning we paid for). An earlier pass in this project concluded that Mathlib had no order-of-vanishing machinery, on the strength of `grep -rl 'orderAt'` returning zero files. It does have it: the declarations are `analyticOrderAt` and `meromorphicOrderAt`, and `grep -rli 'orderat'` returns nineteen. A zero result from a case-sensitive search on a lower-camelCase name is not evidence of absence. Correcting this turned an assumed obstruction into Theorem 3.3.

2 The arithmetic layer

The combinatorial content is separated into a module mentioning no modular form, no η and no upper half-plane: it is a statement about r and N alone. The central definition is Ligozat's cusp-order expression, for $d \mid N$,

$$\text{ord}(N, r, d) = \frac{N}{24} \sum_{\delta|N} \frac{\gcd(d, \delta)^2 r_{\delta}}{\gcd(d, \frac{N}{d}) d \delta},$$

transcribed from [3, Thm. 1.64], together with the two congruences of (1) as predicates `LigozatCongr1` and `LigozatCongr2`. The divisor involution $\delta \mapsto N/\delta$ (Mathlib's `Nat.sum_div_divisors`) gives the duality exchanging the two congruences, formalized as `ligozatCongr1_dual`.

3 Cusp orders, and a correction to our own specification

Theorem 3.1 (Order at every cusp, general N). *etaQuotient_cusp_order*. For every N , every r with $\sum_{\delta} r_{\delta} = 2k$, and every $\gamma \in SL_2(\mathbb{Z})$, writing $c = \gamma_{10}$,

$$\|(f|_k \gamma)(z)\| = \Theta_{\text{Im } z \rightarrow \infty} \exp(-2\pi \text{ord}^{\text{raw}}(N, r, c) \text{Im } z), \quad \text{ord}^{\text{raw}}(N, r, c) = \frac{1}{24} \sum_{\delta|N} \frac{\gcd(c, \delta)^2 r_{\delta}}{\delta}.$$

Two features deserve emphasis. There is *no* congruence hypothesis and *no* $\Gamma_0(N)$ -membership hypothesis: the asymptotic holds for every γ in the full modular group. And the Θ is taken along `atImInfy`, which constrains only $\text{Im } z$; the statement is therefore uniform in $\text{Re } z$ and no approach region is assumed.

Remark 3.2 (The width normalisation — our specification was wrong). This node was originally specified with the exponent written as Ligozat’s $\text{ord}(N, r, c)$. *That statement is false*, and it is not what was proved. Ligozat’s $\text{ord}(N, r, d)$ is an order of vanishing in the local uniformiser $q_h = e^{2\pi iz/h}$ at a cusp of denominator d , where $h = N/\gcd(d^2, N)$ is the width of that cusp for $\Gamma_0(N)$. A decay statement in $\text{Im } z$ therefore carries the exponent ord/h , not ord . Formally, `etaQuotientCuspOrder_eq_width_mul_raw` gives $\text{ord}(N, r, d) = h \cdot \text{ord}^{\text{raw}}(N, r, d)$, so the two exponentials differ whenever $h \neq 1$. The companion statement `etaQuotient_cusp_order_ligozat` spells the exponent as ord/h so that the correction is visible in the statement itself.

Ligozat’s condition (iii) is untouched: $h > 0$, so $\text{ord}^{\text{raw}} \geq 0$ at a cusp if and only if $\text{ord} \geq 0$ there. A hand-computed pin is kept in the development: $f = (\eta(z)\eta(2z))^{12}$ satisfies $\|f|_{12} S\| \asymp \exp(-3\pi y/2)$.

Theorem 3.3 (The cusp ∞ , in Mathlib’s own language). *meromorphicOrderAt_cuspFunction_eq_cuspOrder_1*. For every N , every r , and every $m \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $24m = \sum_{\delta|N} \delta r_{\delta}$,

$$\text{meromorphicOrderAt}(\text{cuspFunction}_1(f))(0) = m,$$

and $m = \text{ord}(N, r, N)$, Ligozat’s value at $d = N$.

This uses Mathlib’s own notion of order, its own cusp function, and its own width (`strictWidthInfy` $\Gamma_0(N)$ 1); we introduce no competing notion of “order at a cusp”. There is no positivity and no holomorphy hypothesis — the order may be negative.

4 Ligozat’s transformation law at small level

Theorem 4.1 (Full transformation law, $N \leq 4$). *ligozat_of_le_four*. Let $0 < N \leq 4$, let $\sum_{\delta|N} r_{\delta} = 2k$, and assume both congruences (1). Let $w : \Gamma_0(N) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^{\times}$ be any homomorphism with $w(T) = 1$, $w(V) = 1$ and $w(-I) = (-1)^k$, where $V = W_N T W_N^{-1}$. Then for every $\gamma \in \Gamma_0(N)$ and every $z \in \mathbb{H}$,

$$f(\gamma z) = w(\gamma) (cz + d)^k f(z).$$

The architecture is worth stating because it is what makes the bounded result possible. A general construction produces a character with this transformation law for every N and with no congruence conditions; what it cannot do is say *which* character. Ligozat’s first congruence pins it at T ; the second pins it at $V = W_N T W_N^{-1}$ — and W_N here is the Fricke involution from the companion development [8], which is where that work is reused; a separate argument pins it at $-I$. For $N \leq 4$ those three elements generate $\Gamma_0(N)$, by a Euclidean descent, so the character is determined and the congruences are upgraded from “conditions at two generators” to the transformation law on the whole group.

Theorem 4.2 (Genus-zero primes). *ligozat_of_prime*. The same conclusion holds for $p \in \{5, 7, 13\}$.

The descent fails at $N = 5$, and not by accident: the development records the explicit counterexample `descent_bound_fails_at_five`. Classically $\bar{\Gamma}_0(5)$ is the free product $\mathbb{Z}/2 * \mathbb{Z}/2 * \mathbb{Z}$, so $\{-I, T, V\}$ cannot generate it and two elliptic generators are needed. That necessity is a literature fact and is *not* formalized here; what is formalized is that this proof needs them — deleting the two elliptic generators and re-running the block leaves exactly two unprovable goals. The replacement tool is a Schreier transversal criterion, `Gamma0_eq_of_schreier`, valid at every prime p : a subgroup containing $-I, T, V$ equals $\Gamma_0(p)$ as soon as it contains one Schreier generator for each $j \in [1, p-1]$. We supply those generators at the three primes where $X_0(p)$ has genus zero.

5 The obstruction at general level

We do not prove Ligozat’s transformation law for general N , and the reason is not a shortage of effort or a choice of proof strategy. It is exact.

Write the multiplier as $w(\gamma) = \exp(\frac{\pi i}{12} \text{per}(\gamma))$, where per is the period cocycle of the weight-two quasi-modular combination $\sum_{\delta|N} r_\delta \delta E_2(\delta z)$. This period is precisely the integration constant that both natural soft routes destroy: the `logDeriv` route differentiates it away, and the 24th-power route (passing to f^{24} , a quotient of discriminants whose modularity Mathlib already has) quotients it away. For a single η this period function *is* Rademacher’s Φ ,

$$\Phi(\gamma) = \frac{a+d}{c} - 12 \text{sign}(c) s(d, |c|) - 3 \text{sign}(c(a+d)),$$

whose non-coboundary content is exactly the Dedekind sum $s(d, |c|)$.

For any level with $\text{genus}(X_0(N)) \geq 1$ — $N = 11$ and most $N \geq 17$ — the group $\Gamma_0(N)$ has hyperbolic generators, and no soft argument evaluates w there: on the free part of $\Gamma_0(N)^{\text{ab}}$, w is constrained only by $w^{24} = 1$, and $\text{Hom}(\Gamma_0(N), \mu_{24})$ is large. Evaluating w in closed form on a single hyperbolic element of $\Gamma_0(11)$ is mathematically equivalent to evaluating a Dedekind sum. Every disguise we attempted reduces back to this: Atkin–Lehner conjugation reintroduces general eta transforms, theta/Poisson routes re-derive the same 24th-root phases, and Wohlfahrt level-24 arguments presuppose the multiplier formula.

What would remove it

In ascending strength, the minimal Mathlib additions are:

- (1) the Dedekind sum $s(d, c)$ and reciprocity;
- (2) Rademacher’s $\Phi : SL_2(\mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ with the cocycle law $\Phi(AB) = \Phi(A) + \Phi(B) - 3 \text{sign}(c_{AC} B C_{AB})$;
- (3) the Petersson–Rademacher multiplier $\eta(\gamma z) = \exp(\pi i (\frac{a+d}{12c} - s(d, c) - \frac{1}{4})) \sqrt{cz+d} \eta(z)$ for $c > 0$.

With (3), general- N Ligozat becomes moderate bookkeeping on top of the argument already formalized here. We note that (2) is best constructed as the period of E_2 using the `E2_slash_action` machinery *already present* in Mathlib — the analytic half exists — which makes it the cleanest available upstream contribution.

Remark 5.1 (A per-instance escape hatch). For a *fixed* N and r , the multiplier on a finite generating set is a ratio of convergent q -products valued in the discrete set μ_{24} . Interval arithmetic with error below $|1 - \zeta_{24}|/2$ therefore *proves* each value. This is an *A2* (program-checked) route for any concrete eta-quotient at any level, requiring no Mathlib addition, though heavy to promote to kernel-checked *A1*.

6 Verification status

lake build SocrateAI completes in 3462 jobs with no errors. The development is 519 declarations in 8117 lines across five modules (`EtaQuotient`, `EtaQuotientCuspOrder`, `EtaQuotientCuspTheta`, `EtaQuotientModularity`, `EtaQuotientPrimeLevel`). There are no sorry placeholders and no project-local axioms. Following [7], the axiom footprint is enforced rather than reported: `FinalCheck.lean` carries 391 `#guard_msgs` in `#print axioms` guards over 389 distinct theorems, so a widened footprint is a compile error; 370 report exactly [`propext`, `Classical.choice`, `Quot.sound`]. A negative control asserting a deliberately wrong footprint is kept outside the build and verified to fail, which is what establishes the guards are load-bearing rather than vacuous.

Of the 453 theorems in the new modules, 14 — three percent — have a one-line `rfl/decide` proof, and 45% quantify over a structure. We report this ratio because an earlier module in this project consisted of 174 numeral identities of which 158 were one-line, and carried no evidential weight; the check is now standard practice here for any large batch.

The statement-dependency graph (`dag/theorems.jsonl`, 57 nodes, 51 proved, acyclic) is machine-validated: every node marked proved must name a declaration that resolves and may depend only on proved nodes. **The node `ETA-01`, Ligozat’s criterion in general, remains open with `lean_name: null`**, and the obstruction node is blocked with `lean_name: null` — for that node the absence of a declaration *is* the content.

7 Related work and prior art

Mathlib has no eta-quotients. The Fermat’s Last Theorem artifact [7] contains substantial eta-related material, but a direct reading shows it is about modular *units* on modular function fields — `modularUnitSeries`, `sharpUnit*`, over Laurent and Hahn series. Its three occurrences of “Ligozat” are *namespace labels* (`LigozatUnitEngine`, `LigozatUnitAL`) on that machinery, not a formalization of the modularity criterion. A GitHub-wide `language:lean` search returns zero for `Ligozat`. We did *not* search the Lean Zulip or open mathlib4 pull requests, and we do not claim coverage there.

8 Limitations

Remark 8.1 (What is not done).

- (a) Ligozat’s criterion for general N is not proved (§5).
- (b) The order of vanishing at a cusp *other than* ∞ is not stated in Mathlib’s `meromorphicOrderAt` language. Mathlib’s width is `widthInfty` only; there is no `widthAtCusp` and no `orderAtCusp`. These are constructible from `conjGL`, `widthInfty` and the slash action, so this is missing API rather than an obstruction. Theorem 3.1 gives the analytic content at every cusp regardless.
- (c) The indexing data is not formalized: that the cusps of $\Gamma_0(N)$ are parametrised by $d \mid N$ with multiplicity $\varphi(\gcd(d, N/d))$, and that $[SL_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \Gamma_0(N)] = \psi(N)$. No index formula for Γ_0 exists anywhere in Mathlib. The definitions `numCusps` and `dedekindPsi` in this development carry those classical readings but do not prove them.
- (d) Theorems 4.1 and 4.2 give the transformation law; assembling it with the cusp-order positivity condition into membership in a bundled `ModularForm` is not yet done.
- (e) That $\{-I, T, V\}$ *cannot* generate $\Gamma_0(5)$ is cited, not proved.

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